



**In the spotlight:** A lightweight title fight between undisputed champion Ilia Topuria (in pic) and interim title holder Justin Gaethje will serve as the main event at the White House. GETTY IMAGES

# When power finds theatre

The Ultimate Fighting Championship turns the heart of US presidency into a combat arena, with Topuria, Gaethje, Pereira and Gane at the centre of a carefully staged **spectacle.**

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In a historic partnership between combat sports and American political heritage, the Ultimate Fighting Championship is set to host UFC Freedom 250 at the USA's highest seat of power, the White House.

Scheduled for June 14, coinciding with Flag Day and in the lead-up to

the nation's 250th anniversary, this event marks the first time a professional mixed martial arts cage has been erected within the grounds of the storied residence.

A temporary, state-of-the-art arena is being constructed to accommodate a select crowd of 4,300, with a significant portion of the seating reserved for active-duty

military personnel and veterans.

The main event features a clash of titans as featherweight champion Ilia Topuria moves up to lightweight to challenge BMF champion Justin Gaethje.

Topuria's technical boxing and elite grappling will be tested against Gaethje's durability and concussive leg kicks.